



Photographs by YOGEN SHAH

in his life. His mother Zeenat, his first wife Kiran, and his psychoanalyst cousin Nuzhat.

while they wait for him to freshen up.

He also seems to be looking better than ever. Khan attributes it to his dietician Vinod Dhurandhar who brought his weight down to 68 kg while making *3 Idiots*. He slept eight hours a day at least and also started playing badminton, sometimes two hours a day, with students at IIM-Bangalore where they shot for *3 Idiots* for over a month. He drinks four litres of water a day. And while friends say he is not above binge drinking, being able to put away several Bacardis for four days in a row, he has stopped smoking for over a year now. "I just went cold turkey," he says. "I realised this with the three-hours-a-day, six-days-a-week training I did for *Ghajini* for over a year. The human mind is a very powerful tool. If it wants something badly, the body will give it. It's like what yogis say." Yet for such a sober individual, Khan can be a fun person, who enjoys learning skiing with his children in Canada as much as he takes pleasure in the piano lessons his wife Kiran gives him. He adores *Calvin & Hobbes* and as is obvious from his well aimed barbs at Shah Rukh, he revels in a little light mischief. The best part about him, says long-time friend, ad man Prasoon Joshi who's worked with him on several campaigns and written songs for some of his films, he doesn't take himself too seriously.

Amit Khanna, chairman of Reliance Entertainment which distributed *3 Idiots*, believes Khan is a throwback to the Dilip Kumar-Raj Kapoor-Dev Anand era when filmmakers lived for cinema and believed it had a higher social purpose beyond making money. "Yet he's as savvy as the new kids on the block, up to speed with Facebook and blogging." Khan doesn't quite put it so grandly. "Money doesn't excite me. It gives me comfort but it's not what makes me tick. Neither does throwing my weight around, or making a noisy entry or making a scene. Give me a great book or a great script any day." Given his anointment as the new box office guru of *gyaan*, there should be no shortage of the latter. ■

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